

MICROSOFT ENTRA IDENTITY GOVERNANCE LAB

Access Reviews • Privileged Access Certification • Least Privilege • Audit Validation

Project Documentation & Improvement Roadmap

Nzweme Identity Security Lab

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Date: September 28, 2026

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Identity Governance Phase 1 — COMPLETE

1. Executive Summary

This document records the Microsoft Entra Identity Governance work completed in the Nzweme Identity Security Lab from the initial governance design through successful access certification, remediation, audit validation, PIM integration preparation, and GitHub publication. The central business problem was to prove that privileged access is not simply granted and left in place indefinitely: it is reviewed, justified, certified, remediated, and auditable.

The completed Phase 1 focused on Microsoft Entra Access Reviews for the SG-IAM-Administrators security group. A legitimate administrator was retained, an inactive test account was denied, the denied membership was removed by applying the review results, and the resulting actions were validated in Microsoft Entra audit logs.

Area	Status	Outcome
Access Review design	Complete	One-time certification configured for SG-IAM-Administrators
Reviewer workflow	Complete	Lab Admin reviewed each identity individually
Decision support	Complete	30-day sign-in activity used for recommendations
Remediation	Complete	Denied user removed by Identity Governance
Audit validation	Complete	Approve, deny, end, apply decision, and apply review recorded
PIM activation controls	Configured	1-hour JIT activation, MFA, justification, ticket, approval
GitHub documentation	Started	Public Microsoft-Entra-Identity-Governance-Lab repository created
Jira integration	Next phase	Change ticket will be referenced during PIM activation

2. Project Objectives

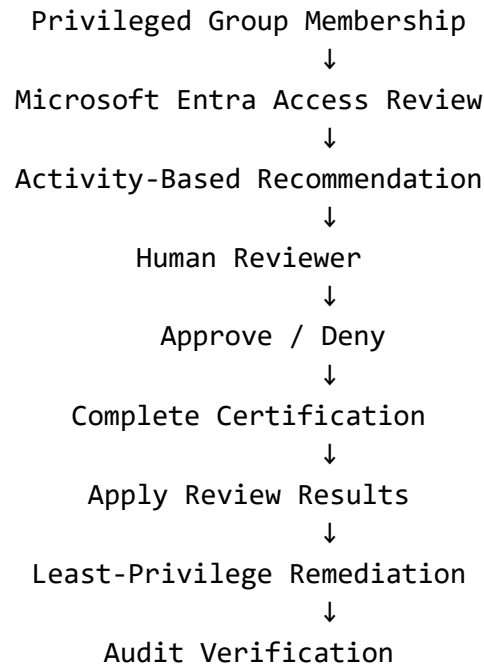
- Implement a realistic privileged-access certification process in Microsoft Entra ID.
- Demonstrate least privilege by removing access that no longer has a business requirement.
- Use Microsoft Entra recommendations as reviewer decision support while preserving human oversight.
- Separate access certification from remediation by disabling automatic application of results.
- Produce an auditable evidence trail suitable for a cybersecurity/IAM portfolio.
- Connect governance to PIM, Conditional Access, change management, and monitoring in later phases.

3. Lab Scope and Key Identities

Object	Purpose
SG-IAM-Administrators	Privileged IAM administration group used for the access-certification exercise
Elie Admin	Legitimate IAM administrator; expected to retain access

Test User01	Simulated stale/inactive privileged member; expected to be removed
Lab Admin	Designated reviewer and lab administrator
SG-PIM-Approvers	Approval group for future PIM JIT activation requests

4. Governance Architecture



5. Implementation Timeline

1. Prepared the privileged group scenario by placing Elie Admin and Test User01 in SG-IAM-Administrators.
2. Created the initial AR001 review as an early test. It was stopped and retained as historical evidence rather than reused.
3. Created AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification as the production demonstration review.
4. Configured a one-time review for Everyone in the group, with Lab Admin as the selected reviewer.
5. Enabled decision assistance using a 30-day sign-in activity window and required reviewer justification.
6. Disabled automatic application of review results so the certification and remediation stages could be demonstrated separately.
7. Reviewed Elie Admin and approved continued access based on legitimate administrative need and recent activity.
8. Reviewed Test User01 and denied access because the account was inactive and had no current IAM administrative requirement.
9. Stopped/completed the review after all decisions were submitted.
10. Applied the review results. After a second application attempt, the review entered Applying state and Microsoft Entra removed Test User01 from SG-IAM-Administrators.
11. Verified the final group membership contained only Elie Admin.
12. Validated the workflow in Access Review audit logs, including Apply decision and Apply review success events.
13. Confirmed Global Administrator PIM activation settings for the next phase.
14. Created the public GitHub repository Microsoft-Entra-Identity-Governance-Lab and began publishing documentation and screenshots.

6. Access Review Configuration

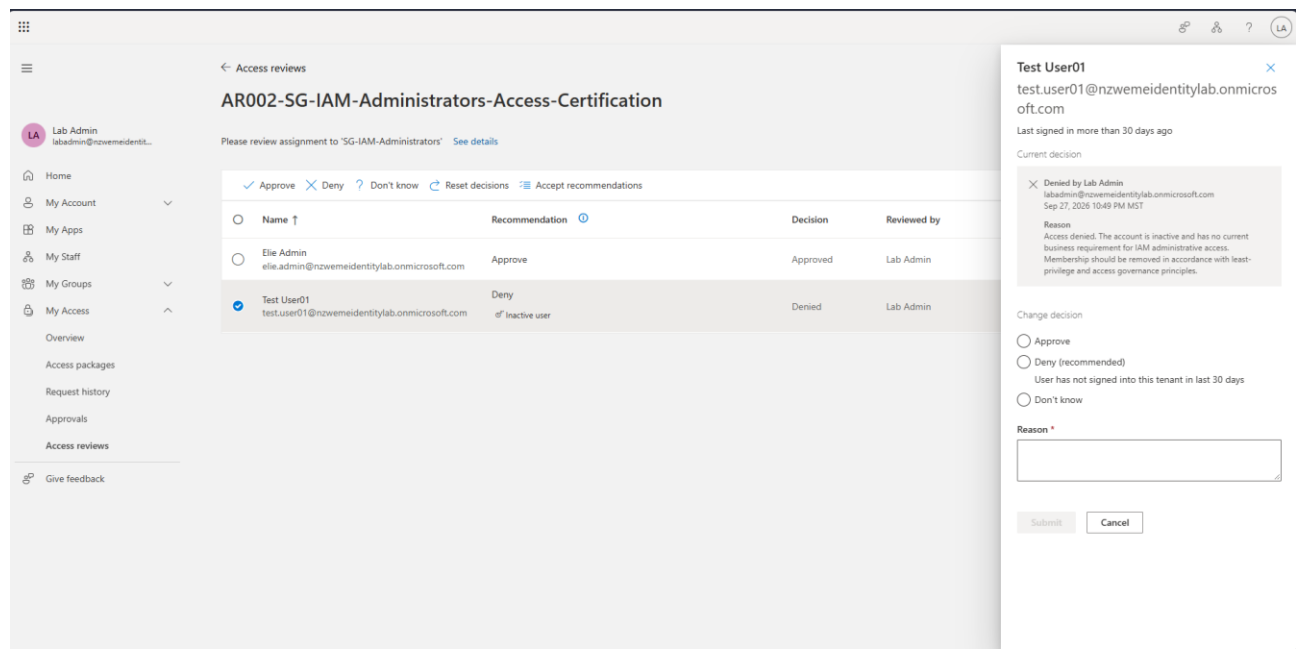
Setting	Configured Value
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Review	AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification
Resource	SG-IAM-Administrators
Scope	Everyone
Reviewer	Lab Admin
Recurrence	One time
Decision assistance	Enabled
Inactivity signal	30 days with no sign-in activity
Justification	Required
Email notifications	Enabled
Reminders	Enabled
Auto-apply results	Disabled
No-response behavior	No change

7. Reviewer Workflow and Decisions

The review intentionally used individual human decisions rather than the bulk “Accept recommendations” action. This demonstrates that automated recommendations support—but do not replace—the reviewer’s accountability.

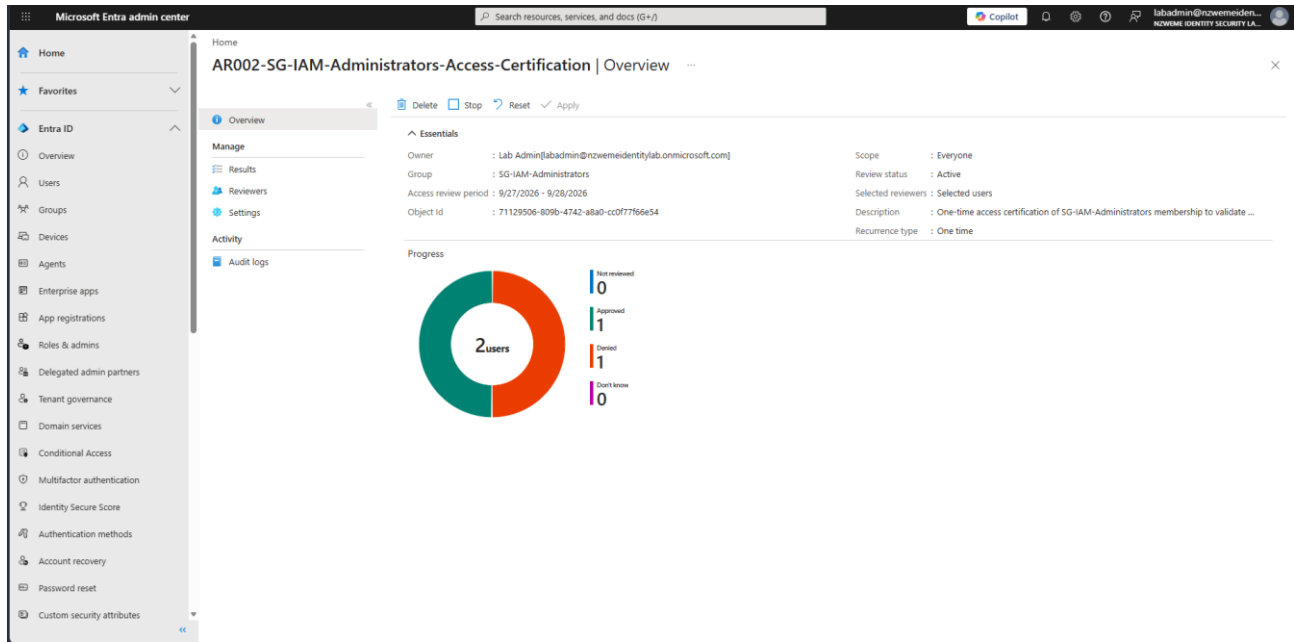
Identity	Entra Recommendation	Reviewer Decision	Result
Elie Admin	Approve	Approve	Access retained
Test User01	Deny — inactive user	Deny	Membership selected for removal



Evidence: final reviewer decisions show Elie Admin approved and Test User01 denied by Lab Admin.

8. Completed Review Results

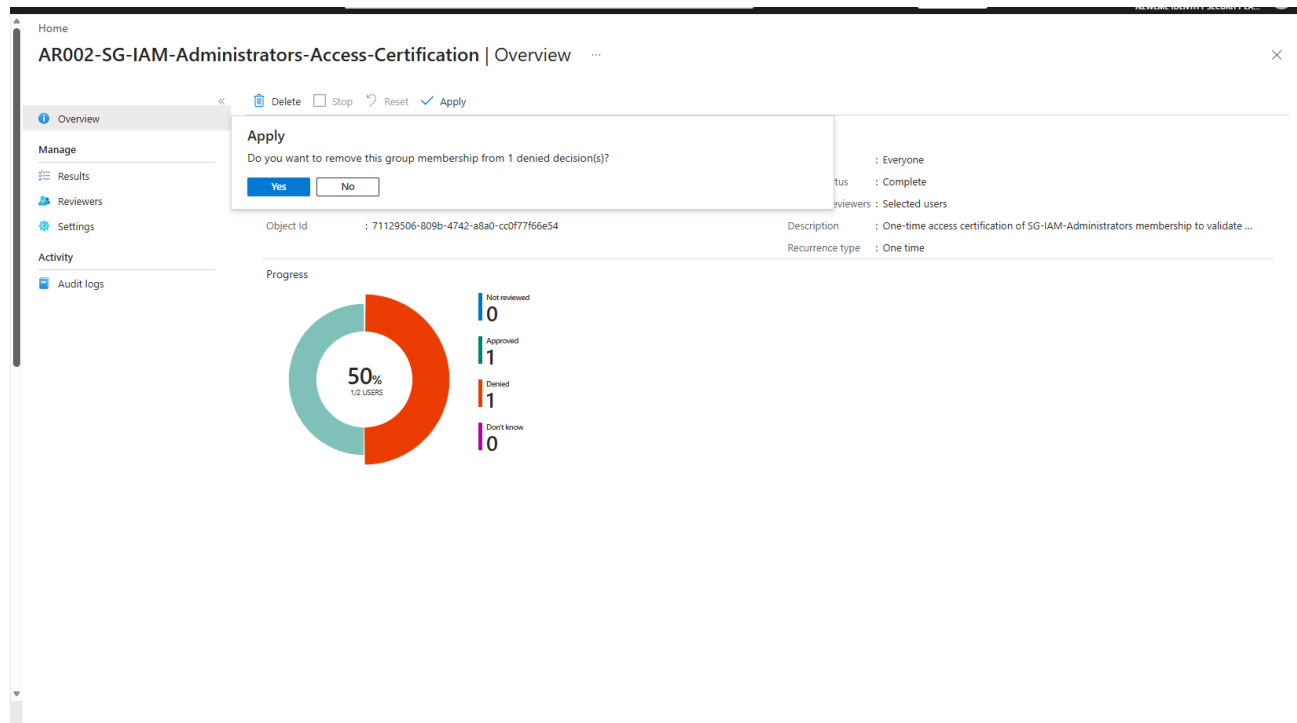
After both decisions were submitted, AR002 showed zero identities left unreviewed, one approval, and one denial. Because automatic result application was disabled, the denied identity remained a member until the remediation step was explicitly applied.



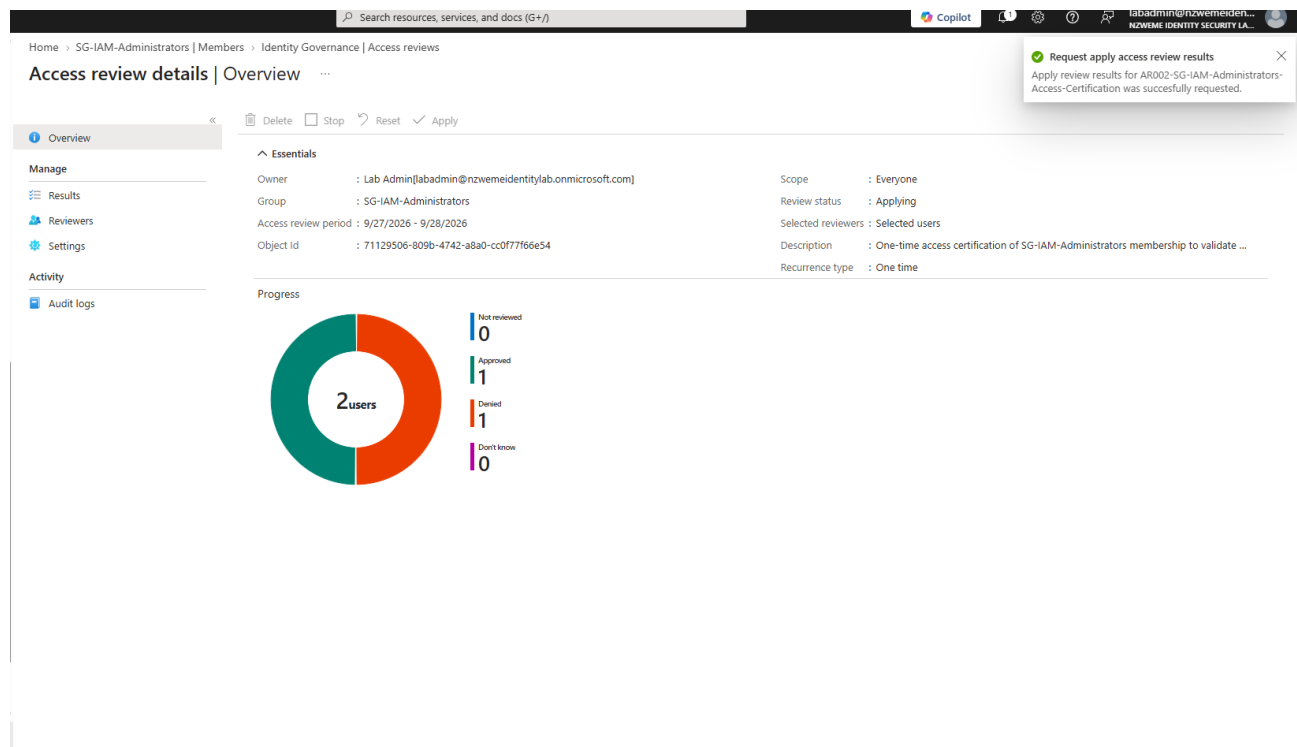
Evidence: AR002 results before remediation — 0 not reviewed, 1 approved, 1 denied.

9. Remediation

The review was completed and the Apply action was used to remove group membership associated with the denied decision. The first attempt did not immediately change membership, so the application process was repeated and verified. On the successful attempt, the review entered the Applying state and the denied account was subsequently removed.



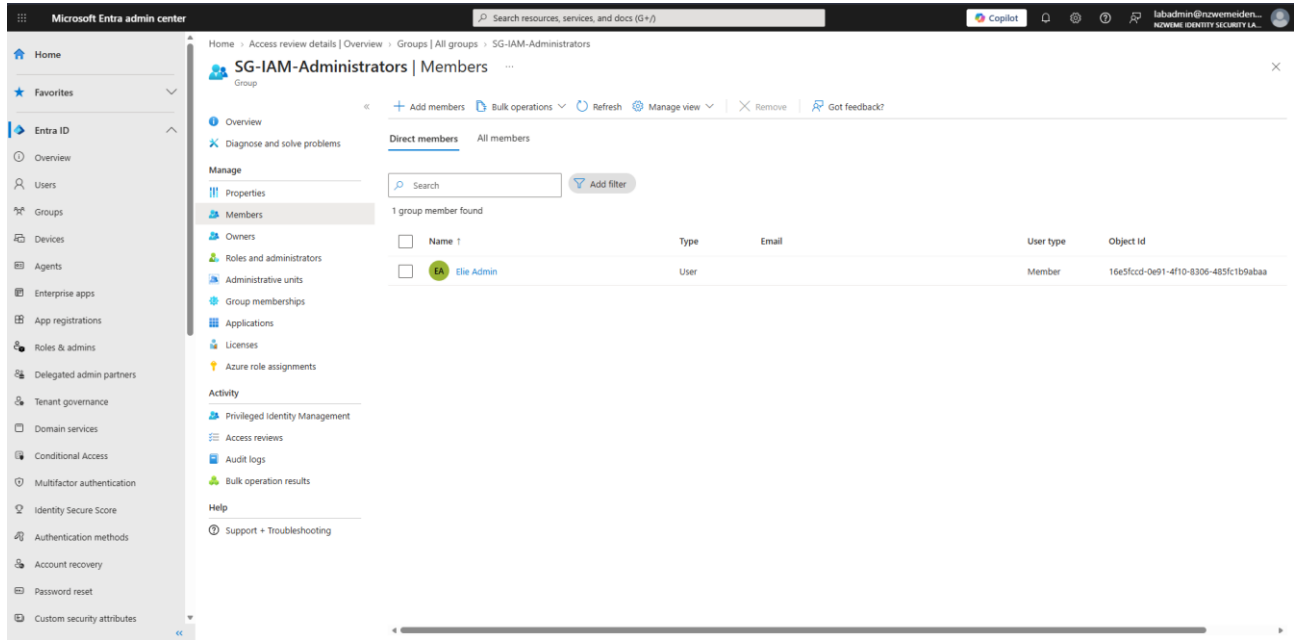
Evidence: manual application of the denied review result.



Evidence: Microsoft Entra shows the review in Applying state after the remediation request.

10. Post-Remediation Verification

The final SG-IAM-Administrators membership was checked independently. Only Elie Admin remained. This proves that Test User01 was removed through the Identity Governance workflow rather than through manual group administration.



Evidence: post-remediation SG-IAM-Administrators membership contains only Elie Admin.

11. Audit Validation

Microsoft Entra audit logs were reviewed to validate the full certification lifecycle. The logs recorded the review creation, reviewer decisions, review completion, decision application, and final review application.

Audit Activity	Observed Status	Purpose
Create access review	Success	Establishes creation of the certification campaign
Approve decision	Success	Records retention decision for legitimate access
Deny decision	Success	Records removal decision for stale access
Access review ended	Success	Records completion of the certification
Apply decision	Success	Records reviewer-initiated remediation request
Apply review	Success	Records Identity Governance processing of applied results

Microsoft Entra admin center

Search resources, services, and docs (G+J)

Copilot

labadmin@nzwemeden...
NORWIDE IDENTITY SECURITY LAB

Password reset

Custom security attributes

Certificate authorities

External identities

Cross-tenant synchronization

Entra Connect

Backup and recovery

Domain names

Custom branding

Mobility

Monitoring & health

ID Protection

ID Governance

Dashboard

Entitlement management

Access reviews

Privileged identity Management

Lifecycle workflows

Verified ID

Global Secure Access

Home > Identity Governance > Access reviews > AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification

AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification | Audit logs

Download Refresh Columns Got feedback?

This view will soon be replaced with a view that includes custom security attribute logs, infinite scrolling, and column reordering. Try out our new audits preview. →

Date: Last 7 days Show dates as: Local Service: Access Reviews Category: All Activity: All Add filters

Date	Service	Category	Activity	Status	Status reason	Target(s)	Initiated by (actor)
9/27/2026, 11:38:35 PM	Access Reviews	UserManagement	Apply review	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Identity Governance
9/27/2026, 11:37:35 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Apply decision	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Lab Admin
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Decision Item Summary	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Identity Governance
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Decision Item Summary	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Identity Governance
9/27/2026, 10:56:10 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Access review ended	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Lab Admin
9/27/2026, 10:49:46 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Deny decision	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Lab Admin
9/27/2026, 10:49:09 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Approve decision	Success		AR002-SG-IAM-Administ...	Lab Admin
9/27/2026, 10:40:26 PM	Access Reviews	Policy	Create access review	Success		0cab8213-4f11-4c00-9dd...	Lab Admin

Evidence: AR002 Access Review audit log showing the certification and remediation event chain.

Home > Identity Governance | Access reviews > AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification

AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification | Audit logs

Overview

Manage

Results

Reviewers

Settings

Activity

Audit logs

«

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Columns

Got feedback?

This view will soon be replaced with a view that includes custom security attribute log

Date: Last 7 days

Show dates as: Local

Service: Access Reviews

Date	Service	Category
9/27/2026, 11:38:35 PM	Access Reviews	UserManagement
9/27/2026, 11:37:35 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:10 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:49:46 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:49:09 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:40:26 PM	Access Reviews	Policy

Audit Log Details

ActivityTarget(s)Modified Properties

Activity

Date9/27/2026, 11:37 PM

Activity TypeApply decision

Correlation ID6d5e461d-bd5f-4e58-80bc-912262c4b06f

CategoryPolicy

Statussuccess

Status reason

User Agent

Initiated by (actor)

TypeUser

Display NameLab Admin

Object ID9ebef361d-2845-4640-8160-ab6a1376fca7

User Principal Namelabadmin@nzwemeidentitylab.onmicrosoft.com

Additional Details

applyResultSuccess

Evidence: Apply decision audit details with applyResult = Success.

Home > Identity Governance | Access reviews > AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification

AR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification | Audit logs

Overview

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Audit logs

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Got feedback?

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Date: Last 7 days

Show dates as: Local

Service: Access Reviews

Date	Service	Category
9/27/2026, 11:38:35 PM	Access Reviews	UserManagement
9/27/2026, 11:37:35 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:11 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:56:10 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:49:46 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:49:09 PM	Access Reviews	Policy
9/27/2026, 10:40:26 PM	Access Reviews	Policy

Audit Log Details

ActivityTarget(s)Modified Properties

Target

TypeAccessReview

Id71129506-809b-4742-a8a0-cc077f66e54

Display NameAR002-SG-IAM-Administrators-Access-Certification

Target

TypeOther

Id8175aa24-18af-4299-8020-9cd7315bf7d8

Display Name

Target

TypeUser

Id9ca0e716-c195-4ea1-8c44-57b80e5b714b

Display NameTest User01

User Principal Nametest.user01@nzwemeidentitylab.onmicrosoft.com

Evidence: Apply decision target includes Test User01.

12. Security Principles Demonstrated

Principle	How the Lab Demonstrated It
Least privilege	Unnecessary privileged group membership was removed after certification.
Access certification	Existing access was re-evaluated instead of being trusted indefinitely.
Human oversight	The reviewer made explicit approve/deny decisions with justification.
Separation of duties/stages	Decision and remediation were separated by disabling auto-apply.
Accountability	Reviewer identity and decisions were captured.
Auditability	The complete lifecycle was recorded in Entra audit logs.
Evidence-based governance	Sign-in activity supported recommendations without replacing human judgment.

13. PIM Readiness for the Next Phase

The project is already prepared to connect access certification with just-in-time privileged activation. The Global Administrator PIM activation settings have been configured for a controlled workflow.

PIM Control	Configuration
Activation maximum duration	1 hour
Authentication requirement	Azure MFA
Justification	Required
Ticket information	Required
Approval	Required
Approver	SG-PIM-Approvers

Microsoft Entra admin center

Home > Identity Governance > Access reviews > Privileged Identity Management > Microsoft Entra roles > Nzweme Identity Security Lab > Roles > Global Administrator > Assignments > Role setting details - Global Administrator

Edit role setting - Global Administrator

Privileged Identity Management | Microsoft Entra roles

Activation Assignment Notification

Activation maximum duration (hours)

0 1

On activation, require

☐ None

☒ Azure MFA

☐ Microsoft Entra Conditional Access authentication context

[Learn more](#)

☒ Require justification on activation

☒ Require ticket information on activation

☐ Require pre-approval custom extension to activate (Preview)

☐ Require post-approval custom extension to activate (Preview)

☒ Require approval to activate

Select approver(s)

0 Member(s), 1 Group(s) selected

If no specific approvers are selected, privileged role administrators/global administrators will become the default approvers.

Selected approvers:

SG-PIM-Approvers

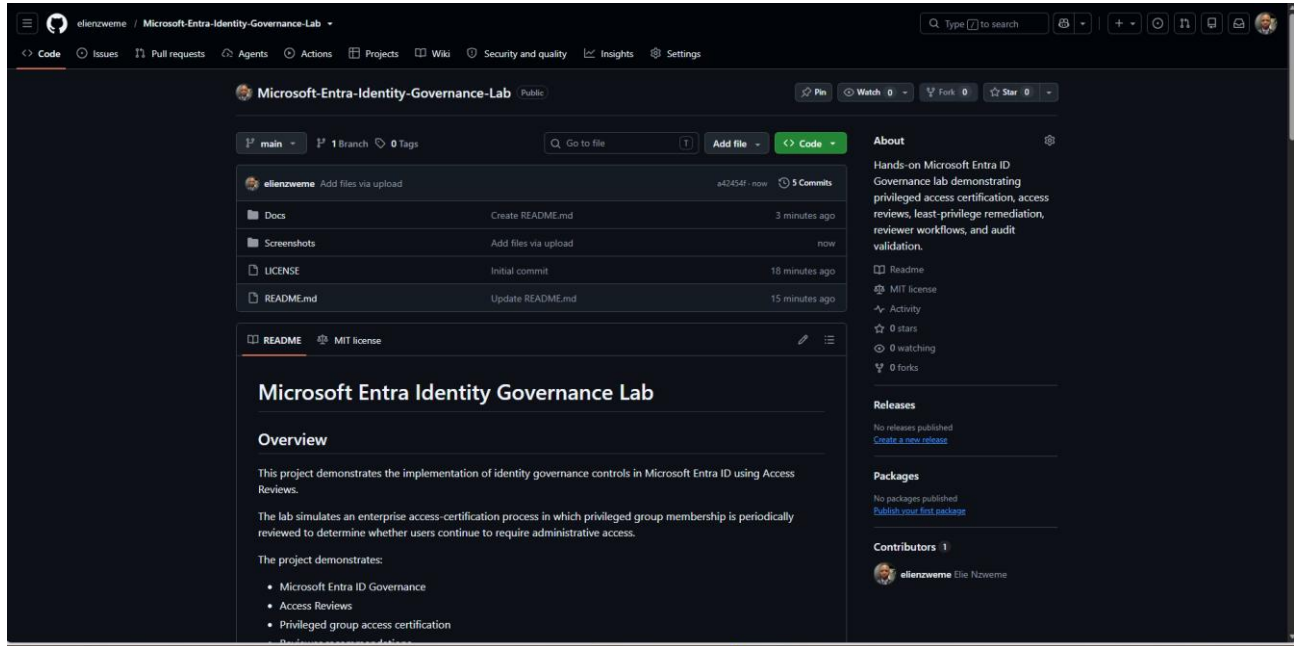
Remove

Update Next: Assignment

Evidence: Global Administrator PIM activation settings prepared for the JIT privileged-access workflow.

14. GitHub Portfolio Publication

A public GitHub repository named Microsoft-Entra-Identity-Governance-Lab was created to present the project as a professional IAM/cybersecurity portfolio artifact. The repository contains a root README, documentation, screenshots, a cover image, and an MIT license.



Evidence: Microsoft-Entra-Identity-Governance-Lab GitHub repository.

15. Current Project Status

Capability	Status
Access Review configuration	Complete
Reviewer workflow	Complete
Approve / deny certification	Complete
Business justification	Complete
Manual result application	Complete
Least-privilege remediation	Complete
Post-remediation verification	Complete
Audit validation	Complete
Identity Governance Phase 1	Complete
PIM activation policy	Configured
Jira integration	Planned
End-to-end JIT activation test	Planned
Conditional Access enforcement migration	Planned
SIEM integration / dashboards	Future enhancement

16. Lessons Learned

- A completed access-review decision is not the same as remediation when auto-apply is disabled; results must be applied.
- The review status and group membership should both be verified after remediation.
- Portal operations can be asynchronous. The successful workflow was confirmed by the Applying state, final membership, and audit events rather than by assuming the first click completed the action.
- Human reviewer justification creates stronger governance evidence than relying only on automated recommendations.
- Audit logs are essential to prove that governance controls performed the intended change.
- Keeping AR001 as historical evidence and completing AR002 cleanly provides a realistic troubleshooting and implementation narrative.

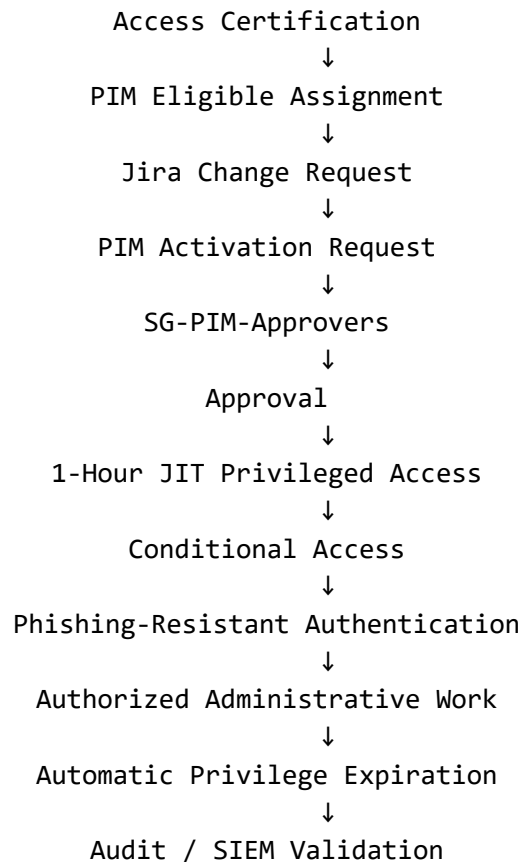
17. Recommended Next Improvements

The next improvements should extend the existing governance control rather than repeat the same access review. The recommended roadmap is:

Priority	Improvement	Expected Evidence
1	Jira change-management integration	Approved Jira ticket referenced in PIM ticket fields
2	End-to-end PIM JIT activation	Eligible → pending approval → approved → active for 1 hour → expired
3	PIM approval validation	SG-PIM-Approvers processes request; approval/denial captured in audit logs
4	Conditional Access linkage	Privileged activation/use tested with phishing-resistant authentication controls

5	Emergency-access validation	Break-glass accounts excluded from lockout-risk policies and monitored
6	Additional Access Review target	Certify SG-PIM-Approvers or SG-Application-Admins to demonstrate governance of approval authority
7	Entitlement Management	Create an access package with request, approval, expiration, and review lifecycle
8	Lifecycle Workflows	Automate joiner/mover/leaver governance tasks in Entra where licensing supports the scenario
9	SIEM monitoring	Forward governance/PIM/CA events to Splunk or another SIEM and build dashboards/alerts
10	Microsoft Graph automation	Query review/PIM status and correlate change tickets programmatically after the manual workflow is stable

18. Target End-to-End Enterprise Workflow



19. Portfolio Summary

This lab demonstrates more than configuration of an Entra feature. It shows a defensible privileged-access governance process: access is identified, reviewed, justified, certified, remediates, independently verified, and audited. The next phase will connect this governance decision to PIM just-in-time activation and Jira change management, creating a broader enterprise identity-security workflow.

20. Repository and Author

Item	Value
Project	Microsoft Entra Identity Governance Lab
Repository	Microsoft-Entra-Identity-Governance-Lab
Author	Elie Nzweme
GitHub	elienzweme
LinkedIn	elienzweme
Portfolio	elienzweme.com
Project date	September 28, 2026